



q & a

8 million

The number of Ubuntu users in the world

was no drive detected in the BIOS. Everything works fine when I unplug the SATA cable for the drive and restart.

Initially, I thought this might be a hard drive error, so I changed it but still the problem persisted. This time, the BIOS detected the HDD, but the same boot problem occurred

My PC specifications are:

Processor: AMD Phenom 9550 x4

Motherboard: ASUS M3A78-EM

Hard drive: 160 GB Seagate Barracuda (older) / 160 GB Western Digital Caviar(now)

Memory: Transcend 1 GB DDR 800 x 2

Palit HD4850 512 MB DDR3

500 W power supply

Operating System: Vista Home Premium

APC UPS, MoserBaer DVD writer.

Also, I have a few questions.

1. Is this configuration good enough for playing high-end games such as Crysis, and Far Cry 2?
2. Should I consider upgrading my RAM to 4 GB?
3. Is upgrading the motherboard's BIOS necessary?

Soumit Sarkar

A The problem might not be with the drive, but with the SATA cable or the connector on the motherboard. Try switching the cable to another SATA slot or even trying new SATA cables.

Your system is sufficient for the games you've mentioned. The move to 4 GB will help a bit but not enough. Memory prices are low, so it's a good time to upgrade anyway. Upgrading your motherboard's BIOS is only necessary if there are compatibility or major performance issues.

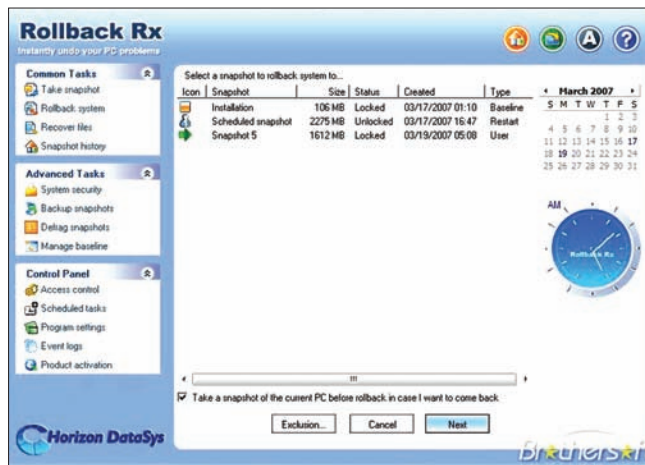
Q I want a hidden recovery partition!

Please suggest how I can create hidden recovery partitions in Windows XP?

A Use Rollback Rx or Norton Go Back software program but be careful to only use the software for a single, main system partition.

Jagdeep Virdi

(TECH QNA Expert)



Rollback RX allows saving and restoring backups

Q Windows errors!

When I click on the Add/Remove icon in the Control Panel, I get an error saying 'value creation failed at line 451'. The desktop PC has a Pentium 4 HT processor running Windows XP with 768 MB RAM. The DVD driver is a year old and I also have Nero 7 installed.

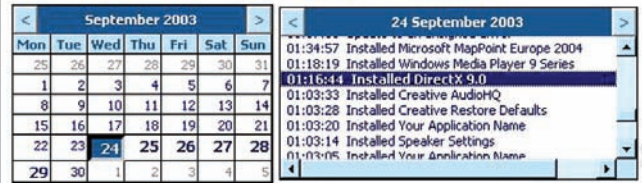
A Run this command in the Run window `sfc /scannow`. It checks your system files for any corruption. You can also reinstall Windows with a Repair option. Another option is to use system restore

The following calendar displays in bold all of the dates that have restore points available. The list displays the restore points that are available for the selected date.

Possible types of restore points are: system checkpoints (scheduled restore points created by your computer), manual restore points (restore points created by you), and installation restore points (automatic restore points created when certain programs are installed).

1. On this calendar, click a bold date.

2. On this list, click a restore point.



The sfc command is a file checker built into Windows

from Start > All Programs > Accessories > System tools > System Restore. Use a Safe restore point where your OS runs perfectly.

Jagdeep Virdi
(Tech QNA Expert)

Q Windows thinks I'm not logged in

My Task Manager doesn't indicate the user name and it also says that I'm not logged in. I am running Windows XP SP2.

My PC configuration is:

Pentium 4 2.66 GHz

Intel D101GGC motherboard

80 GB hard disk

512 MB RAM

A Open the Run command window using [Windows] + [R]
Insert Windows XP CD
Type `sfc /scannow`

Jagdeep Virdi
(Tech QNA Expert)

Q Can't read Ubuntu partitions

I have installed Windows XP (SP2), Windows Vista (Ultimate) and Linux(Ubuntu). I have one problem. I dedicated one drive for the Linux installation. Now, that drive is not shown when I use Windows XP or Vista. All my drives are shown when I boot into Linux. How can I use my drive in Windows if it is possible without formatting Linux. I have dedicated 73 GB to that Linux drive.

My system configuration is:

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E4600

Memory: 2 GB

A Windows cannot recognise the partition formatted with Linux file systems whereas Linux supports the FAT/NTFS file systems. This is why you cannot see your Linux partition under Windows.

Sanjeev Chharia
(Tech QNA Expert)

Q PC is running too slow

I have a Compaq CQ60 Laptop with Windows XP SP2 with RAM 2 GB and 22 GB hard disk. My first query is that I have installed Vista Inspire 2 on it to have a look like Vista. Is that fine? I copied the setup of a large imaging suite into my second partition and now I think that my laptop is responding slowly.

Manav Dhiman

A Copying large data doesn't make your computer slower. It might be due to the Vista Inspire that you have installed or maybe due to a virus. Try uninstalling the Vista Inspire to check if the speed increases, or perform an online scan of your computer from www.kaspersky.com.

Aditya Rupani
(Tech QNA)